

NESS HERITAGE

Hiroshima Peace Memorial

User Guide & AR Experience Companion

Augmented Reality Tour - Heritage Guide Agent - Multilingual

Welcome to NESS Heritage

NESS Heritage is an augmented reality experience that lets visitors explore the Hiroshima Peace Memorial Park in immersive 3D. The park commemorates the atomic bombing of Hiroshima on August 6, 1945, and stands as a global symbol of peace and the urgent call for nuclear disarmament.

This guide explains every feature of the app so you can make the most of your visit: navigating the park, choosing points with A La Carte, scanning landmarks, listening to audio narration, switching languages, conversing with the AI Historian and the Survivor Storyteller, and downloading this companion document.

Getting Started

Starting the Experience

- Open the app and tap "Begin AR Experience" on the home screen to enter the AR tour.
- The tour loads a 3D model of the memorial park with all 50 outdoor heritage points.
- Walk to the museum entrance and tap it to step inside the Peace Memorial Museum, which adds 80 scannable exhibits.

Camera / AR Mode

- Tap the camera icon (top-right) to overlay the 3D scene on your live camera feed for a true augmented reality view.
- Grant camera permission when prompted. If the camera is unavailable, the experience works fully in 3D scene mode.

Navigating the Park

The Pink Fluorescent Path

A glowing pink fluorescent line winds through the entire park, connecting all 50 memorial landmarks in tour order. A bright dot travels along the path to show the recommended direction of travel. Follow this line to visit every heritage point in sequence.

Camera Controls

- Drag with one finger to orbit around the scene.
- Pinch with two fingers to zoom in and out.
- Use the "Next Stop" button at the bottom to fly the camera to the next landmark along the path.

The Peace Memorial Museum

Entering and Exiting

- In the park, find the museum building marked by a glowing cyan entrance marker. Tap it to step inside.
- The scene switches to a 3D floorplan of the museum interior with partitioned gallery rooms.
- Use the back arrow (top-left) to return to the park at any time, or tap the amber exit marker inside the museum.

The Blue Fluorescent Path

Inside the museum, a glowing blue fluorescent line replaces the outdoor pink path. It starts at the entrance doorway and winds through the central corridor into every gallery room, guiding you past all 80 museum exhibits in tour order. A bright dot travels along the path to show the recommended direction.

- Outdoor navigation uses the pink path; museum navigation uses the blue path.
- Tap any glowing blue marker to scan a museum exhibit, just like outdoor landmarks.

Scanning Landmarks

Each memorial landmark is marked by a pulsing glowing sphere - pink outdoors and blue inside the museum. To learn about a landmark:

- Tap any glowing pink marker in the scene.
- A scanning animation confirms the landmark is being analyzed.
- After a moment, an information panel slides up with the landmark description and historical context.
- Close the panel with the X button to return to the park and scan another point.

A La Carte Visit

Prefer to choose your own route? Tap the list icon (top-right) to open the A La Carte panel. Browse every scannable point across the park and museum, switch between Outdoor and Museum tabs, and search by name. Tap any point to fly the camera straight to it and scan it - no need to follow the path in order.

Proximity Alerts

As you move through the park or museum and approach a scannable point, NESS Heritage gives you a gentle nudge. When you get near a heritage point or museum exhibit, the app vibrates gently (on supported devices) and shows a "Near: <name> - Tap to scan" prompt at the top of the screen. Tap the prompt to scan that point immediately, so you never miss a point of interest nearby.

Audio Narration

When you scan a landmark, its story is read aloud automatically using text-to-speech. A speaker icon in the information panel lets you mute or unmute narration at any time. The narration follows your selected language.

Capturing Photos

While viewing a landmark information panel, tap "Capture" to snap a photo of the monument. In AR mode the photo includes your live camera view with the 3D overlay. Photos are saved to your personal collection on this device. From the home screen, tap "My Collection" to view, download, or remove your saved photos.

Language Switcher

NESS Heritage welcomes international visitors. Tap the globe icon (top-right) to choose your preferred language. The landmark descriptions and historical context are translated on demand, and the audio narration speaks in your chosen language.

Supported languages:

- English, Mandarin Chinese, Hindi, Spanish, French, Arabic, Bengali, Russian, Portuguese, Urdu, Indonesian, German, Japanese, Swahili, Marathi, Telugu, Turkish, Tamil, Korean, Thai, Italian.

The first scan in a new language may take a moment while the translation is prepared. Repeat scans in the same language appear instantly thanks to built-in caching.

The AI Historian (Paid)

For a deeper understanding, NESS Heritage includes an expert AI Historian. When you scan a landmark, tap "Guide" in the information panel to open a conversation. The historian explains the historical significance of the scanned landmark in detail and answers your follow-up questions.

- The historian retrieves detailed information about the landmark you scanned.

- Ask anything: what happened here, who is commemorated, key dates, the meaning of the monument.
- The historian responds in your selected language when you request it.
- Close the conversation with the X button to return to the park.

Paying with MetaMask

The AI Historian is a paid feature. When you tap "Guide", if you do not have active access, a payment panel appears. Choose how much time you want - from 30 minutes up to 10 hours, in 30-minute steps. The cost is \$1 USD per 30 minutes. You pay the equivalent amount in Ethereum (ETH) using the MetaMask wallet; the live ETH price is fetched automatically so you see the exact ETH amount before you confirm. After payment, your access is saved on this device and you can open the historian for any landmark until your time runs out.

The Survivor Storyteller (Paid)

As you approach a memorial location, NESS Heritage can relay a personal survivor story - a respectful, human, first-person narrative conveying the experience and resilience of someone who lived through the bombing. When you scan a landmark, tap "Story" in the information panel to hear a survivor story connected to that place.

- Stories are told in a dignified, composite, representative voice - they do not claim to be a specific real identified individual.
- The storyteller responds in your selected language when you request it.

Registration Required

To use the Survivor Storyteller you must be registered with an email and signed in. If you are not signed in, tapping "Story" takes you to the login/register screen first.

Paying with MetaMask

The Survivor Storyteller is a paid feature with the same terms as the AI Historian: \$1 USD per 30 minutes, from 30 minutes up to 10 hours in 30-minute steps, paid in Ethereum via MetaMask. Your access is saved on this device and lets you open the storyteller for any landmark until your time runs out.

Offline Mode

Before heading to the park, tap "Prepare Offline Mode" on the home screen to download all 50 landmark records and the tour guide content to your device. Once prepared, the AR tour, landmark information, audio narration (text-to-speech runs on your device), and the Heritage Guide (showing saved content) all work without an internet connection. An "Offline" indicator appears in the tour when you are using saved data.

Downloading This Guide

This user guide is available as a PDF from the home screen. Tap "Download User Guide (PDF)" to save a copy to your device for offline reference during your visit.

The 50 Outdoor Heritage Points

The park contains 50 scannable outdoor heritage points. The five central landmarks form the core of the memorial; the remaining points honor the many groups and individuals affected by the bombing. Each is listed below in tour order.

1. The A-Bomb Dome (Genbaku Dome)

The skeletal remains of the Hiroshima Prefectural Industrial Promotion Hall, one of the few buildings left standing near the hypocenter of the atomic blast on August 6, 1945.

Historical context: Originally completed in 1915 and designed by Czech architect Jan Letzel, this building stood just 160

meters from the hypocenter. Its steel frame and stone walls partially survived the blast while everything around it was leveled. In 1996, it was designated a UNESCO World Heritage Site as a stark reminder of the first use of nuclear weapons and a symbol of the hope for lasting peace.

2. The Cenotaph for A-Bomb Victims

A stone, saddle-shaped monument enshrining the registry of names of all known victims of the atomic bombing of Hiroshima.

Historical context: Designed by architect Tange Kenzo and unveiled on August 6, 1952, the cenotaph's curved form evokes a clay Haniwa house of ancient Japan, sheltering the souls of the departed. Its inscription reads: 'Let all the souls here rest in peace, for we shall not repeat the evil.' The registry now contains over 320,000 names and is updated each year.

3. The Eternal Flame of Peace

A flame that has burned continuously since August 1, 1964. It will remain lit until the day all nuclear weapons on Earth are eliminated.

Historical context: The flame was ignited using fire brought from the sacred Toshogu Shrine in Ueno, Tokyo, combined with a flame kindled from the embers that lingered in the ruins of Hiroshima after the bombing. It stands as a perpetual, living call for nuclear disarmament, embodying the determination that no city should ever again suffer such destruction.

4. The Peace Bell

A large bronze bell that visitors may ring as a prayer for world peace, designed by sculptor Masahiko Katori and installed in 1964.

Historical context: One side of the bell depicts a map of the world without national borders, symbolizing the unity and wholeness of the planet. The opposite side shows the atomic bomb's blast as a mirror of destructive power. Together they ask visitors to reflect: will we choose connection or annihilation? The bell's sound carries the prayer for peace across the park.

5. The Pond of Peace

A tranquil reflecting pool that lies between the Cenotaph and the Flame of Peace, mirroring the sky and the monuments that surround it.

Historical context: The pond creates a deliberate visual axis connecting three elements: the Cenotaph for the victims, the Eternal Flame, and the A-Bomb Dome. When viewed through the arch of the Cenotaph, the flame and the dome align across the water, forming a unified memorial landscape that draws visitors from around the world to pause and reflect on the cost of war and the value of peace.

6. Children's Peace Monument

A monument dedicated to Sadako Sasaki and all children who perished as a result of the atomic bombing.

Historical context: Sadako Sasaki was two when the bomb fell. She later developed leukemia and began folding paper cranes, believing a thousand would grant her wish to live. She died at twelve. The monument, topped by a girl holding a golden crane, was funded by children across Japan and unveiled in 1958.

7. Atomic Bomb Memorial Mound

A grassy mound containing the ashes of tens of thousands of unidentified victims of the atomic bombing.

Historical context: In the chaotic aftermath, cremated remains of roughly 70,000 victims were gathered with no means of identification. They were brought to this mound in 1955. Buddhist memorial services are held here each August 6.

8. Monument to the Mobilized Students

A memorial honoring students conscripted into wartime labor who perished in the bombing.

Historical context: Thousands of students were mobilized to work in factories and on demolition crews. Many were outdoors clearing fire lanes on August 6. The monument bears the words of a student describing the cruel fate of those whose studies were cut short by war.

9. Monument in Memory of Korean Victims

A memorial honoring the Korean victims of the atomic bomb, many brought to Japan as forced laborers.

Historical context: Around 20,000 Koreans lived in Hiroshima at the time of the bombing, many conscripted for forced labor. An estimated 10,000 to 20,000 were killed. The monument features a crown and clasped hands and was moved into the park in 1999.

10. Hiroshima Peace Memorial Museum

The principal museum documenting the destruction of Hiroshima and the ongoing call for nuclear abolition.

Historical context: Opened in 1955, the museum displays artifacts recovered from the ruins: scorched clothing, stopped watches, and personal belongings. Its exhibits trace the events of August 6, 1945, the human toll, and the global effort to eliminate nuclear weapons.

11. National Peace Memorial Hall

A national hall commemorating the atomic bomb victims and preserving their memories.

Historical context: Opened in 2002, the hall provides a quiet space for reflection. Its design evokes flowing water, echoing the victims' desperate cries for water. A registry of victims' names and photographs is maintained here.

12. Aioi Bridge

The distinctive T-shaped bridge that served as the target point for the atomic bomb.

Historical context: The Aioi Bridge's unusual T-shape made it an easily recognizable landmark from the air. The bomb was aimed at this bridge and detonated almost directly above it. The bridge was rebuilt after the war and remains in use today.

13. Fountain of Prayer

A fountain offering water to the victims who cried out for it in their final moments.

Historical context: Many who survived the initial blast suffered severe burns and desperately sought water before dying. This fountain, built in 1964, stands as a response to those cries and as a prayer for peace.

14. Rest House

A surviving pre-war building now serving as a visitor rest area within the park.

Historical context: Built in 1929 as a kimono shop, this building was about 170 meters from the hypocenter. Its concrete structure survived while nearly everything nearby was destroyed. It now houses exhibits and serves as an information center.

15. Monument to Teachers and Students

A memorial for the teachers and students of Hiroshima who lost their lives in the bombing.

Historical context: Many schools were operating in makeshift classrooms or had students engaged in labor when the bomb fell. This monument records the names of over 300 teachers and more than 9,000 students from Hiroshima Prefecture who perished.

16. Tower of Orphans

A monument for the children left orphaned by the atomic bombing.

Historical context: An estimated 2,000 to 6,500 children lost both parents to the bomb. Many were taken in by relatives or orphanages; some lived on the streets. This tower honors their lost childhoods and the struggles they endured.

17. Monument to Fallen Firefighters

A memorial for the firefighters who died battling the fires that consumed Hiroshima.

Historical context: On August 6, the city's firefighters were mobilized to fight the immense fires that erupted across the city. Many died in the effort. This monument honors their sacrifice and bravery.

18. Peace Watch Clock

A clock tower showing the number of days since the last nuclear test and days since the bombing.

Historical context: The clock displays two counters: days since the atomic bombing of Hiroshima, and days since the most recent nuclear weapons test anywhere in the world. The second counter resets each time a test occurs, a sobering reminder that the threat persists.

19. Statue of Mother and Child

A bronze statue depicting a mother sheltering her child beneath her.

Historical context: Unveiled in 1960, the statue represents a mother shielding her child from the blast. It stands as a symbol of parental love and the instinct to protect the young, even in the face of unimaginable destruction.

20. Statue of the Merciful Goddess

A statue of Kannon, the Buddhist goddess of mercy, watching over the souls of the victims.

Historical context: The statue, created by artist Katsuzo Entsuba in 1955, depicts Kannon with a peaceful expression. A relief on its base shows a mother and child. It embodies the wish for compassion and the repose of the departed.

21. Monument of Prayers for Peace

A memorial expressing the collective prayers of Hiroshima for lasting world peace.

Historical context: Erected by citizens' groups, this monument gathers the prayers of people from around the world. Visitors often leave paper cranes and messages here, adding their voices to Hiroshima's enduring call for peace.

22. Wind Shelter

The remains of an underground air-raid shelter used during the bombing.

Historical context: These underground shelters were built throughout the city for protection against air raids. On August 6, some who sheltered here survived the initial blast, though many later died from injuries or radiation. The remains are preserved as a witness to that day.

23. Hypocenter Marker

A marker indicating the point on the ground directly beneath where the bomb exploded.

Historical context: The bomb detonated at an altitude of approximately 580 meters above this spot. The marker identifies the precise location over which the explosion occurred, a place of solemn remembrance for all who were lost in an instant.

24. A-Bombed Ginkgo Tree

A ginkgo tree that survived the atomic blast and sprouted new leaves the following spring.

Historical context: Located about 1,100 meters from the hypocenter, this ginkgo tree was stripped bare by the blast but survived. It sent out new buds in the spring of 1946. It stands as a living symbol of resilience and the endurance of life.

25. A-Bombed Eucalyptus Tree

A eucalyptus tree that survived the bombing and continues to grow today.

Historical context: Found within the temple grounds near the hypocenter, this eucalyptus endured the heat and blast. Its survival astonished those who believed nothing could live through such destruction. It remains a testament to nature's tenacity.

26. Motoyasu Bridge

A bridge spanning the river beside the A-Bomb Dome, close to the hypocenter.

Historical context: The Motoyasu Bridge was heavily damaged by the blast but remained partially standing, allowing many survivors to flee the fires. It was rebuilt after the war. Its railings bear the marks of that day, preserved as evidence.

27. Memorial for Municipal Girls' School

A memorial for the students of the Hiroshima Municipal Girls' School who died clearing buildings.

Historical context: On August 6, about 500 students from this school were working to demolish buildings for a fire lane

near the hypocenter. Nearly all perished instantly. This memorial honors the young lives lost in that devastating moment.

28. Monument to Mobilized Workers

A monument for the civilian workers mobilized for wartime production who died in the bombing.

Historical context: During the war, factories across Hiroshima relied on mobilized workers. Many were killed at their posts on August 6. This monument honors those who labored and died, their names and sacrifices remembered.

29. Gate of Peace

A gateway marking one of the entrances to the Hiroshima Peace Memorial Park.

Historical context: The gate serves as a threshold between the city and the memorial park, inviting visitors to step from the everyday world into a space of reflection. Its design frames the path toward the Cenotaph and the dome beyond.

30. Statue of Prayer

A statue of a figure in prayer, hands clasped, seeking peace for the victims.

Historical context: Created by sculptor Katsuzo Entsuba, this bronze figure embodies the act of prayer itself. It faces the river and the dome, silently interceding for those who died and for a future free of nuclear weapons.

31. Monument to Chinese Victims

A memorial for the Chinese nationals who died in the atomic bombing of Hiroshima.

Historical context: Among the victims were Chinese civilians and conscripted laborers brought to Japan during the war. This monument, erected in 2004, recognizes their suffering and ensures they are not forgotten among the dead.

32. Monument to American POWs

A memorial honoring the American prisoners of war who were killed by the atomic bomb.

Historical context: At least twelve American airmen were being held in Hiroshima as prisoners of war when the bomb fell. Most were killed. This monument, erected in 1998, acknowledges their deaths alongside the many thousands of other victims.

33. Students' Memorial Monument

A general monument honoring all students who died as a result of the atomic bombing.

Historical context: Beyond those from individual schools, countless students from across the prefecture were affected. This monument gathers their memory, inscribed with the hope that no student anywhere will again know such a fate.

34. Monument to Newspaper Workers

A memorial for the journalists and newspaper workers who died in the bombing.

Historical context: The Chugoku Shimbum newspaper's Hiroshima office was near the hypocenter. Many journalists and staff were killed. This monument honors those who worked to tell the city's story and who lost their lives on August 6.

35. Monument to Communication Workers

A memorial for postal and telecommunications workers who died in the bombing.

Historical context: Hiroshima was a communications hub. Postal and telegraph workers were among those killed on August 6. This monument remembers their service and the lives lost while maintaining the city's lines of communication.

36. Phoenix Monument

A monument shaped like a phoenix, symbolizing Hiroshima's rebirth from ashes.

Historical context: The phoenix, a mythical bird that rises renewed from its own destruction, was adopted as a symbol of Hiroshima's postwar recovery. This monument expresses the city's determination to rebuild and to carry the message of peace to the world.

37. Sankichi Toge Poem Stone

A stone inscribed with the poem 'Set the Heart Aflame' by atomic bomb survivor Sankichi Toge.

Historical context: Sankichi Toge survived the bombing and became a poet and activist. His poem begins: 'Give back the human lives, give back the human beings.' The stone preserves his words as a permanent cry against nuclear weapons.

38. Monument to Gas Workers

A memorial for the workers of the Hiroshima Gas Company who died in the bombing.

Historical context: The Hiroshima Gas Company's facilities were near the hypocenter. Many workers were killed at their posts. This monument honors their lives and the essential service they provided to the city.

39. Clock Tower of Peace

A clock tower within the park marking the time of the bombing, 8:15 AM.

Historical context: The clock on this tower is set to 8:15, the moment the bomb fell. It stands as a permanent marker of that instant when time stopped for so many, and as a reminder that the world must ensure it never happens again.

40. A-Bombed Streetcar

A restored Hiroshima streetcar that survived the atomic bombing.

Historical context: Several streetcars were running when the bomb fell. One, restored and returned to service, now operates as a moving memorial. It carries passengers through the rebuilt city, a reminder of what endured and what was lost.

41. Memorial for Lumber Workers

A memorial for the workers at the Hiroshima lumber yards who died in the bombing.

Historical context: Hiroshima was a center for lumber processing. The lumber yards along the rivers employed many workers who were killed on August 6. This memorial honors their labor and their lives.

42. Monument to Municipal Workers

A memorial for the city employees of Hiroshima who died in the atomic bombing.

Historical context: Many municipal workers were at their posts or engaged in civil defense duties when the bomb fell. This monument remembers the public servants who died serving their city on that day.

43. Second Senior High School Memorial

A memorial for the students of the Hiroshima Second Senior High School who perished.

Historical context: Students from this school were engaged in agricultural labor outside the city when the bomb fell. Many who returned to search for family were exposed to radiation. This memorial honors the students whose lives were forever altered.

44. Literature Mobilization Monument

A monument for the writers and intellectuals mobilized during the war who died in the bombing.

Historical context: During the war, writers and intellectuals were organized into a literature mobilization to support the war effort. Some were in Hiroshima on August 6. This monument honors the voices that were silenced by the bomb.

45. Water and Light Memorial

A memorial combining a fountain and light, symbolizing life and hope.

Historical context: Water and light are recurring motifs in the peace park, recalling the victims' cries for water and the light of hope for the future. This memorial unites the two, offering a space for quiet contemplation.

46. Rainbow Monument

A colorful monument representing the bridge of peace between peoples and nations.

Historical context: The rainbow, a symbol of hope and connection across division, inspired this monument. It stands for the bonds of solidarity that link Hiroshima with peace-loving people and cities around the world.

47. Dove of Peace Statue

A statue of a dove taking flight, the universal symbol of peace.

Historical context: The dove has been a symbol of peace for millennia. This statue, depicting a dove in flight, represents the wish that peace may spread outward from Hiroshima to every corner of the earth.

48. Bell of Nagasaki

A bell connected in spirit to the atomic bombing of Nagasaki, joining the two cities in remembrance.

Historical context: Three days after Hiroshima, a second atomic bomb fell on Nagasaki. This bell links the two cities in shared mourning and in a shared determination that nuclear weapons must never be used again.

49. Memorial Stone for the Unidentified

A stone memorial for those whose names were never known and whose bodies were never found.

Historical context: Thousands of victims were cremated where they were found, or disappeared entirely in the blast and fires. Many could never be identified. This stone honors all those who rest here without a name.

50. Flame of Tolerance

A small flame monument symbolizing understanding and reconciliation among peoples.

Historical context: Beyond the call for disarmament, Hiroshima's message includes reconciliation and tolerance among former enemies. This flame represents the light of understanding that must guide humanity away from war.

The 80 Museum Exhibits

Inside the Peace Memorial Museum, 80 scannable exhibits display artifacts, testimonies, and records from the bombing. Each is listed below in tour order, following the blue path from the entrance.

2. Shinichi's Tricycle

A child's tricycle recovered from the ruins, a poignant symbol of young lives lost.

Historical context: Three-year-old Shinichi Tetsutani was riding it when the bomb fell. His father buried it with him; it was later excavated and donated to the museum.

3. The Stopped Watch

A wristwatch frozen at 8:15, the moment of the blast.

Historical context: Thousands of watches stopped at 8:15 a.m. on August 6, 1945, each marking the instant its owner perished.

4. Burned Clothing

Scorched garments worn by victims, preserved as evidence of the heat.

Historical context: The fireball's surface temperatures exceeded 3,000C; clothing was often the only remains of its wearer.

5. Sadako's Paper Cranes

Paper cranes folded by Sadako Sasaki, wishing for life.

Historical context: Sadako developed leukemia from the bombing and folded cranes until her death at twelve, becoming a global peace symbol.

6. Survivor Testimonies

Recorded accounts of hibakusha sharing their memories.

Historical context: These voices form the emotional core of the museum's call for a world without nuclear weapons.

7. Hiroshima Before and After

Panoramas of the city before and after August 6, 1945.

Historical context: A thriving castle town was reduced to ashes in seconds, then rebuilt as a beacon of peace.

8. The Nuclear Abolition Movement

The global effort to eliminate nuclear weapons, from Hiroshima to today.

Historical context: Hiroshima's mayors have protested every nuclear test for decades, sustaining a worldwide movement.

9. A-Bomb Dome Model

A scale model of the Genbaku Dome as it stood after the bombing.

Historical context: The dome's skeletal frame, preserved at the hypocenter, is a UNESCO World Heritage symbol of peace.

10. Charred Lunchbox

A burnt lunchbox carrying a child's morning meal, never eaten.

Historical context: Many such lunches were found beside their young owners, untouched since the morning of the blast.

11. Melted Glass Bottles

Bottles fused together by the heat, their forms twisted and merged.

Historical context: Glass deformed at over 700C, illustrating the extreme temperatures near the hypocenter.

12. The Human Shadow

The eerie shadow of a person etched into stone by the heat rays.

Historical context: A person sitting on the bank steps was vaporized, leaving a lasting silhouette on the granite.

13. Torn Roof Tiles

Roof tiles shattered and scorched by the blast and heat.

Historical context: Across miles of the city, tiles were stripped from homes and their glazes bubbled by the heat.

14. A Child's Scorched Kimono

A child's kimono burned in the bombing.

Historical context: Family members donated clothing such as this, often the only trace of a lost child.

15. The Stopped Bank Clock

A bank clock stopped at 8:15, kept since the blast.

Historical context: The clock remains frozen at the exact moment the bomb fell, preserved by the bank.

16. Melted Rosary

A rosary with beads melted together, found in the ruins.

Historical context: Personal religious items were found throughout the city, their materials fused by the intense heat.

17. The Peace Declaration Archive

Texts of the annual Peace Declarations read at the memorial ceremony.

Historical context: Each August 6, Hiroshima's mayor delivers a declaration renewing the call for nuclear abolition.

18. Photographs of the Hypocenter

Photographs documenting the hypocenter and surrounding devastation.

Historical context: These images record the precise point above which the bomb detonated 600 meters in the air.

19. Hibakusha Drawings

Drawings and paintings by survivors recalling the day of the bombing.

Historical context: Many hibakusha later rendered their memories in art to convey what words could not.

20. Melted Coins

Coins fused into a single mass by the heat of the blast.

Historical context: Money carried in pockets was often found melted together, another measure of the inferno's heat.

21. The Memorial Register

The register listing the names of all known victims of the bombing.

Historical context: Over 350,000 names are inscribed, updated each year as more are recognized and remembered.

22. Scorched Textbook

A student's textbook, singed and curled by the fire.

Historical context: Many schoolchildren were working to clear firebreaks that morning and perished with their books.

23. A Woman's Burnt Sandal

A single sandal, one of the few remains of its wearer.

Historical context: Grieving families donated personal effects, sometimes a single shoe, as their only memento.

24. The Flame of Peace Relay

The story of the flame lit from the fires of the bombing, kept at the park.

Historical context: Lit in 1964 from flames gathered from the ruins, it burns until nuclear weapons are abolished.

25. Papers Blown by the Blast

Documents and letters scattered miles by the shockwave.

Historical context: Leaflets, homework, and photographs were carried on the wind far from their owners, found for years after.

26. The Mangled Bicycle

A bicycle twisted and crushed by the blast's pressure.

Historical context: The shockwave crushed metal and wood alike within a wide radius of the hypocenter.

27. A Stopped Pocket Watch

A pocket watch halted at the moment of detonation.

Historical context: Like the stopped wristwatches, it records the exact instant of the explosion.

28. Charred Rice Paddle

A burnt rice paddle from a kitchen destroyed in the blast.

Historical context: Household items like this are preserved as traces of ordinary lives interrupted.

29. The Hiroshima Recovery

The story of the city's rebuilding after the war.

Historical context: Amid the ashes, survivors began to rebuild, eventually restoring Hiroshima as a city of peace.

30. Medical Supplies of the Aftermath

Medical materials used in the desperate relief efforts following the bombing.

Historical context: With most doctors dead and hospitals destroyed, care was improvised in the streets.

31. Letters from Hibakusha

Letters survivors sent to one another and to the world.

Historical context: These personal letters trace decades of suffering, solidarity, and hope.

32. Hibakusha Health Records

Records of the long-term health effects endured by survivors.

Historical context: Survivors faced increased cancer rates and lifelong discrimination, documented in these records.

33. Children's Peace Drawings

Drawings by children from around the world expressing hopes for peace.

Historical context: Thousands of children send artwork to Hiroshima each year, collected in this archive.

34. The Cenotaph Cornerstone

Design elements of the Cenotaph for the A-bomb Victims.

Historical context: The cenotaph holds the Memorial Register and symbolizes shelter for the souls of the dead.

35. A Melted School Satchel

A school satchel, its leather warped and fused by heat.

Historical context: Many children were carrying these satchels when the bomb fell and never returned home.

36. The Hypocenter Model

A model showing the hypocenter and the bomb's altitude of detonation.

Historical context: The bomb exploded about 600 meters above this spot, unleashing heat, blast, and radiation.

37. Heat Ray Damage Specimens

Specimens showing the heat rays' effects on stone, glass, and metal.

Historical context: Near the hypocenter, surfaces were charred and deformed by the intense thermal radiation.

38. Blast Pressure Specimens

Objects illustrating the destructive force of the shockwave.

Historical context: The pressure wave leveled nearly every structure within two kilometers of the hypocenter.

39. Radiation Effects Exhibit

An exhibit explaining the radiation's effects on the human body.

Historical context: Radiation caused both immediate deaths and long-term illness among those exposed.

40. Rescue and Relief Efforts

The relief efforts by survivors, students, and volunteers.

Historical context: With infrastructure destroyed, ordinary citizens carried the wounded to rivers and aid stations.

41. The Atomic Bomb Mechanism

An exhibit explaining how the bomb was constructed and detonated.

Historical context: The 'Little Boy' bomb released energy through nuclear fission, described here for visitors.

42. World Nuclear Arsenals History

A timeline of global nuclear weapons since 1945.

Historical context: Tens of thousands of warheads remain today, underscoring the urgency of the call for abolition.

43. Mayors for Peace

The global network of mayors advocating nuclear abolition.

Historical context: Founded by Hiroshima in 1982, Mayors for Peace now unites thousands of cities worldwide.

44. The Origami Crane Monument

A display of thousands of paper cranes honoring Sadako and other children.

Historical context: Visitors fold and bring cranes to the park and museum as offerings of peace and remembrance.

45. The Peace Bell (Replica)

A replica of the Peace Bell visitors may ring for peace.

Historical context: The bell, inscribed with a map of the world, is rung with prayers for peace and an end to war.

46. Victims' Personal Effects

A wall of personal items belonging to those killed in the bombing.

Historical context: Family members donated these everyday objects so their loved ones would not be forgotten.

47. The Day of the Bombing Timeline

A minute-by-minute account of August 6, 1945.

Historical context: From the alert to the flash and the aftermath, this timeline traces the day in detail.

48. The Sound of the Blast

An audio archive of survivor recollections of the roar of the bombing.

Historical context: Survivors describe the sound and silence of the explosion, preserved here as testimony.

49. The River of the Dead

Paintings of those who fled to the rivers seeking water and relief.

Historical context: Countless wounded gathered at the Motoyasu River; their images have endured in survivor art.

50. The Rebirth of Hiroshima

The story of Hiroshima's revival as a city of peace.

Historical context: From ruins, the city renewed itself around a vow never to repeat the tragedy.

51. A World Without Nuclear Weapons

The closing exhibit, a pledge and a vision of a peaceful future.

Historical context: This gallery invites visitors to carry forward the wish that no city ever again endures what Hiroshima did.

52. The Paper Crane Chains

Long chains of paper cranes sent to Hiroshima by people around the world.

Historical context: Each chain represents a wish for peace; millions of cranes arrive each year and are displayed in rotating exhibits.

53. A-Bomb Survivor Photographs

Portraits of hibakusha paired with their recorded testimonies.

Historical context: These photographs put faces to the statistics, humanizing the suffering behind the numbers.

54. The Hiroshima Maidens

The story of the Hiroshima Maidens, women who suffered severe burns and sought healing abroad.

Historical context: In 1955, twenty-five young women traveled to the United States for reconstructive surgery, becoming symbols of reconciliation.

55. Nobuko's Tricycle

A small tricycle belonging to a child named Nobuko, recovered from the ruins.

Historical context: Like Shinichi's tricycle, it stands for the youngest lives lost and the families who kept their memory.

56. The School of Honkawa

A memorial to the students of Honkawa National School, located near the hypocenter.

Historical context: Over 400 children and teachers at Honkawa perished; the surviving building now houses a peace museum.

57. The Atomic Bomb Dome Bell

The bell that hung in the A-Bomb Dome, damaged but preserved.

Historical context: The bronze bell survived the blast and is displayed as a witness to the morning of August 6, 1945.

58. Melted Roof Tiles from the Dome

Roof tiles recovered from the ruins of the Genbaku Dome.

Historical context: Their scorched and blistered surfaces show the heat that engulfed the building nearest the hypocenter.

59. The Hiroshima Carp and Recovery

How the Hiroshima Carp baseball team lifted the city's spirits after the war.

Historical context: Founded in 1949, the Carp became a symbol of the city's recovery and resilience.

60. Survivor's Handkerchief

A handkerchief carried by a survivor, stained and singed.

Historical context: Such small personal items are often the only tangible remains of a person's last moments.

61. The Fire Cistern

A fire cistern that served as a desperate water source on the day of the bombing.

Historical context: Thousands suffering severe burns rushed to the rivers and cisterns seeking relief; many died there.

62. A Mother's Letter

A letter a mother wrote to her child who never came home.

Historical context: Parents searched for years; some left letters at memorial sites, preserved here as testimony of grief.

63. The Tram Car

A model of the Hiroshima streetcar that ran through the city on the morning of the bombing.

Historical context: Many tram workers and passengers were killed instantly; the streetcar system was rebuilt within days as a sign of recovery.

64. Hiroshima Station Clock

The station clock stopped at the moment of detonation.

Historical context: Hiroshima Station, though damaged, became a hub for evacuation and relief in the days that followed.

65. The Bridge of Spoken Words

The story of a bridge where survivors gathered and shared news.

Historical context: Bridges over the Ota River became meeting points where the wounded sought one another and help.

66. Charred Nails

Nails from destroyed homes, bent and blackened by the heat.

Historical context: Where whole houses vanished, only nails and foundation stones remained to mark where families lived.

67. The Water Cistern

A water cistern that witnesses recall as a site of desperate thirst.

Historical context: Survivors begged for water, which was often unavailable; giving water too quickly sometimes proved fatal.

68. A Soldier's Helmet

A military helmet pierced and scorched by the blast.

Historical context: Soldiers stationed in Hiroshima were among the victims; this helmet recalls their presence.

69. The Red Cross Hospital Records

Records from the Red Cross Hospital, one of the few that functioned after the bombing.

Historical context: Doctors and nurses worked around the clock with almost no supplies, documenting cases that still inform radiation medicine.

70. Melted Buddha Statue

A bronze Buddha figure, its surface melted and warped by the heat.

Historical context: Religious icons across the city were damaged, reflecting the indiscriminate reach of the destruction.

71. The Atomic Bomb Survivors Memorial

A memorial to the community of hibakusha and their decades of advocacy.

Historical context: Survivors endured illness and discrimination while leading the global call for nuclear abolition.

72. Children's Monument Stones

Stones gathered by children and inscribed with messages of peace.

Historical context: School groups place these stones at the memorial as part of peace education programs.

73. The Peace Clock Tower

The story of the Peace Clock Tower in the memorial park.

Historical context: The tower chimes each day at 8:15, marking the moment of the bombing and the wish for peace.

74. A Burned Flag

A burned flag recovered from the ruins of a public building.

Historical context: Tattered national and municipal symbols were found throughout the devastated city.

75. The Hiroshima Prefectural Hall Model

A model of the Hiroshima Prefectural Industrial Promotion Hall, now the A-Bomb Dome.

Historical context: The hall was a proud civic building before the war; its skeleton remains the park's most iconic structure.

76. Survivor's Eyeglasses

A pair of eyeglasses found in the ruins, their frames twisted by heat.

Historical context: Such ordinary objects are preserved as traces of the individuals who wore them.

77. The Mobilized Students Memorial

A tribute to the student laborers mobilized to demolish buildings for firebreaks.

Historical context: Thousands of mobilized students died at their work sites when the bomb fell; many were teenagers.

78. A Melted Comb

A comb, its teeth fused together by the intense heat.

Historical context: Personal grooming items like this are often the only remains found in a family's home.

79. The Toro Nagashi Lantern Festival

The tradition of floating paper lanterns on the rivers to honor the dead.

Historical context: Each August 6, thousands of lanterns are set afloat, carrying prayers for the victims and for peace.

80. The Hiroshima Symphony

The story of the Hiroshima Symphony, composed in memory of the bombing.

Historical context: Music has become part of the city's mourning and hope, performed annually at the memorial ceremony.

81. The Global Peace Pledges Wall

A wall of pledges for peace collected from visitors worldwide.

Historical context: Millions have signed pledges here, committing to carry the memory of Hiroshima forward.

NESS Heritage - Preserving memory through technology. This guide accompanies the NESS Heritage augmented reality application.